

Dinosaur world

The Mesozoic Era is the name for the time when dinosaurs dominated the Earth. Lasting for over 180 million years, this enormous era is divided into three time periods called the Triassic, Jurassic, and Cretaceous. As the climate changed and new types of plants grew, different animals appeared. To describe when these periods were we shorten “million years ago” to MYA.

Triassic period

The Triassic period (252–201 MYA) was the hottest time in dinosaur history. The dry, desert landscape was bare, except for plants growing by riverbanks and coastlines. Small dinosaurs and tiny mammals began to appear on the Earth for the first time.

Creepy-crawlies including spiders, scorpions, and millipedes had appeared before the Triassic period.

Pleuromeia, a type of treelike plant, grew to 6 ft (2 m).

plateosaurus

Coelophysis

Eoraptor

Jurassic period

The Jurassic period (201–145 MYA) saw changing seasons. A combination of high temperatures and rainfall caused flourishing forests. The lush vegetation included tall trees and widespread plants, providing a reliable food supply for huge plant-eating dinosaurs.

Stegosaurus

Allosaurus

Insects like dragonflies and beetles flew through the air.